

Fishing for Sustainability — Round 2

Fixed-Quota Harvesting

Name: _____

Goal

Test whether a **group quota** improves sustainability and trust.

Materials (Instructor provides)

- Reset lake to **30 fish**.
- Same 8 boats (cups).

Biological Rule

After harvest, fish remaining in the lake **double** (up to **30**).

Communication Rules (Read aloud & follow exactly)

- **Discussion Allowed (2 minutes) ONLY** to agree on **one total class quota** for this round (e.g., “We will catch at most 16 fish total”).
- After the 2-minute discussion ends and a quota is agreed upon, **no further discussion**, signaling, or eye contact about choices.

i You may communicate (for 2 minutes max):

- Propose and agree on a single **total class quota** (number of fish).

You may NOT communicate (after the timer):

- Your personal intended catch or any hints about it.
- Any signals during harvesting.

Procedure

1. **Set the Quota (group, 2 minutes):** Agree on a **total class quota** for this round:
Class quota = _____ fish
2. **Secret Choice (0–6):** After discussion ends, privately choose how many fish to take (0–6). **Do not reveal** your number.
3. **Simultaneous Harvest:** When the instructor says “**Fish!**” everyone takes their chosen fish at the same time.
4. **Check Quota Outcome:**
 - If **Total class catch** > **Class quota** → **Collapse** (0 fish survive or reproduce). **Stop.**
 - If **Total class catch** ≤ **Class quota** → Instructor counts remaining fish, then **doubles** them (up to 30).
5. **Record** your results.

Data Table (Round 2)

Item	Value
Agreed class quota	
Your catch	
Total class catch	
Fish remaining after harvest	
Fish after reproduction (doubled, max 30)	

Individual Reflection (submit with this handout)

1. Was it easy to keep the class within the quota? Why or why not?
2. Did anyone appear to “cheat”? How did that affect your trust?
3. Compared to Round 1, did the population fare better, worse, or the same? Explain briefly.

4. Name **one** real-world challenge managers face when implementing quotas.

Participation Check (instructor initials when reviewed)

- ☐ Data table filled
- ☐ Four reflection answers written

Stop here. Hand this sheet in. Wait quietly for the next handout.